

IOT Innovations v. Signify Netherlands B.V. et al

The public analysis reports that the accused product set includes smart-lighting and IoT systems and describes the six asserted patents as reaching natural-language processing, automated device registration, network communication protocols, and dynamic messaging.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-23	U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Texas	2:26-cv-00736	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-27. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	IOT Innovations LLC v. Signify Netherlands B.V. et al
FORUM / DOCKET	U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Texas / 2:26-cv-00736
FILED / TYPE	2026-08-23 / patent infringement
PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

The public E.D. Texas docket identifies IOT Innovations LLC v. Signify Netherlands B.V. and Signify N.V., No. 2:26-cv-00736, as a patent action filed August 23, 2026 under 35 U.S.C. § 271. The docket identifies Carey Matthew Rozier as plaintiff counsel and describes the complaint's attachments as evidence-of-use charts for U.S. Patent Nos. 7,209,876; 7,280,830; 7,593,428; 8,972,576; 7,246,173; and RE44,742. The docket page is a public secondary docket reproduction, not the court-hosted complaint.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

C. Matthew Rozier - Partner, Rozier Hardt McDonough PLLC; docket-listed plaintiff counsel. The public docket identifies Carey Matthew Rozier as counsel for IOT Innovations on the complaint, disclosure statement, and patent form. The firm's current public team page identifies C. Matthew Rozier as a partner and lists the direct professional email below.

matt@rhmttrial.com - publicly printed in the [linked professional source](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

The public analysis reports that the accused product set includes smart-lighting and IoT systems and describes the six asserted patents as reaching natural-language processing, automated device registration, network communication protocols, and dynamic messaging.

Secondary-source limitation: This is not the complaint or an evidence-of-use chart. It does not establish infringement, claim construction, or the actual behavior of a particular Signify product/version. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[7,209,876](#) | [7,280,830](#) | [7,593,428](#) | [8,972,576](#) | [7,246,173](#) | [RE44,742](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Natural-language request handling

Does any alleged app or cloud feature receive a natural-language question, identify a variable answer field, query a repository, and generate an answer in the claimed sequence?

Potential evidence: Product demos, app/cloud source code, prompt and retrieval architecture, API logs, test traces, release histories, and claim charts.

02 Device registration and home relationship

During Hue/WiZ onboarding, what entity recognizes a device, establishes credentials, links it to a local network or account, and performs each alleged registration step?

Potential evidence: Pairing flows, bridge/phone traffic, firmware, onboarding instructions, cloud records, credentials, and controlled device tests.

03 Gateway, device, and cloud allocation

Which function occurs in the bulb, bridge/gateway, mobile app, LAN, and cloud service—and does the alleged system satisfy limitations that require a particular network actor or relationship?

Potential evidence: Architecture diagrams, source code, protocol traces, API documentation, network captures, and offline/failure testing.

04 Wireless and IP communications

Which protocols and message paths are actually used for discovery, pairing, addressing, control, state reporting, authentication, and remote access?

Potential evidence: Protocol specifications, radio/network captures, firmware, SDKs, device configuration, and test reports.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Dynamic messaging and control

How are lighting commands, state changes, schedules, automation rules, notifications, and device events formed, addressed, delivered, and acted upon?

Potential evidence: Rule-engine design, message schemas, source code, event logs, app behavior, backend records, and version-specific testing.

06 Historical product behavior

Which versions were sold or operated in the relevant periods, and did firmware, apps, APIs, or cloud changes alter the material operation?

Potential evidence: Release notes, build artifacts, source-control records, update logs, archived manuals, and preserved-device testing.

07 Reissue claim scope and POSITA

How should the reissue patent's claims be read against the intrinsic record and what would a person of ordinary skill have understood about networked home-device design at the relevant dates?

Potential evidence: Prosecution/reissue record, patent specification, contemporaneous standards, textbooks, technical papers, and a supported POSITA definition.

08 Inducement and use pathways

What user instructions, configuration steps, or normal product workflows are alleged to cause an end user to perform a claimed method?

Potential evidence: Manuals, setup guides, in-app prompts, marketing material, support documentation, usage analytics, and customer workflows.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 David E. Culler, PhD

Professor Emeritus, Electrical Engineering and Computer Sciences, University of California, Berkeley

TECHNICAL FIT

Wireless embedded systems, TinyOS, sensor networks, 6LoWPAN/IPv6, and device-to-cloud networking.

RELEVANT WORK

Berkeley identifies work including Berkeley Motes, TinyOS, PlanetLab, wireless embedded systems, and networking; he is an NAE member.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public testimony was located in this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Emeritus status and any present industry or expert engagements require diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | culler@berkeley.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Shwetak Patel, PhD

Washington Research Foundation Entrepreneurship Professor, University of Washington; Distinguished Scientist and head of Health Technologies, Google

TECHNICAL FIT

Ubiquitous computing, sensing, embedded systems, home-energy monitoring, and connected-device architecture.

RELEVANT WORK

UW lists ubiquitous computing, sensing and embedded systems and identifies Zensi and SNUPI Technologies among his startups.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public testimony was located in this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Google role may pose conflict or independence questions; availability cannot be assumed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | shwetak@cs.washington.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Mani B. Srivastava, PhD

Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering and Computer Science, UCLA

TECHNICAL FIT

Embedded software, cyber-physical systems, IoT, security, privacy, and energy-aware computing.

RELEVANT WORK

UCLA lists embedded software, Internet of things, security/privacy, and energy-aware computing; he is an ACM Fellow.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public testimony was located in this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

May need pairing with a product-specific firmware or cloud-evidence practitioner.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | mbs@ee.ucla.edu | [public email source](#)

04 David Kotz, PhD

Pat and John Rosenwald Professor of Computer Science, Dartmouth College

TECHNICAL FIT

Pervasive computing, wireless networks, smart environments, and sensor-rich connected devices.

RELEVANT WORK

Public Dartmouth materials describe more than 280 papers and 12 patents spanning pervasive computing, smart homes, and wireless systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

His public materials note consulting through Harbor Experts but do not identify a specific litigation engagement.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Prior consulting/opinions must be screened; broader system fit rather than a particular protocol.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | David.F.Kotz@dartmouth.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Anind K. Dey, PhD

Dean and Professor, Information School, University of Washington; adjunct faculty, Allen School

TECHNICAL FIT

Context-aware and ubiquitous computing, sensor hierarchies, and user-facing connected-system behavior.

RELEVANT WORK

UW describes research in context-aware computing, active learning, behavior modeling, and sensor-rich environments.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed UW materials do not identify expert-testimony work.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

HCI/context focus may need supplementation for firmware or radio implementation.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | anind@uw.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Deborah Estrin, PhD

Robert V. Tishman Professor of Computer Science and Associate Dean for Impact, Cornell Tech

TECHNICAL FIT

Embedded networked sensing, mobile/wireless systems, and networked-device design tradeoffs.

RELEVANT WORK

Cornell identifies Estrin as founding director of the NSF Center for Embedded Networked Sensing and describes pioneering mobile/wireless work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed Cornell profile does not identify expert-testimony work.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Current public emphasis is digital health; product-specific application needs diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | destrin@cornell.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Mahadev Satyanarayanan, PhD

Jaime Carbonell University Professor of Computer Science, Carnegie Mellon University

TECHNICAL FIT

Mobile/pervasive systems, edge computing, device-cloud partitioning, latency, and resilience.

RELEVANT WORK

CMU describes work in mobile and pervasive computing, cloudlets, edge computing, and IoT systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed CMU materials do not identify expert-testimony work.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Architecture focus may need a wireless-protocol or embedded-hardware specialist.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | satya@cmu.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Anthony Rowe, PhD

Siewiorek and Walker Family Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering and CyLab, Carnegie Mellon University

TECHNICAL FIT

Real-time embedded sensing/control, low-power implementation, and cyber-physical systems.

RELEVANT WORK

Rowe's public work concerns networked real-time embedded systems that couple sensing with control actions.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public testimony was located in this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Public materials identify an industry chief-scientist role, requiring conflict diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | agr@andrew.cmu.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Ramesh Govindan, PhD

Northrop Grumman Chair in Engineering and Professor of Computer Science, University of Southern California

TECHNICAL FIT

Scalable routing, wireless/mobile networks, robust infrastructure, and network measurement.

RELEVANT WORK

USC describes research in scalable routing, Internet structure, and architectures/programming systems for wireless and mobile networks; he is an ACM and IEEE Fellow.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public testimony was located in this bounded review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Network architecture focus is less direct for consumer-device UI or product management.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | ramesh@usc.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Julie A. Kientz, PhD

Professor and Chair, Human Centered Design & Engineering, University of Washington

TECHNICAL FIT

Mobile/sensor applications, configuration workflows, and how smart-system behavior is presented to and controlled by users.

RELEVANT WORK

UW lists mobile and sensor application research in health, education, and family settings.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed UW materials do not identify expert-testimony work.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Best paired with systems specialist for protocol, firmware, or security questions.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | jkientz@uw.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/texas/txedce/2:2026cv00736/248625>

Public professional email source: <https://rhmtrial.com/about/>

Public technical context source: <https://ai-lab.exparte.com/case/dct/txed/2%3A26-cv-00736/doc/analysis/1>

LIMITATIONS

This is not the complaint or an evidence-of-use chart. It does not establish infringement, claim construction, or the actual behavior of a particular Signify product/version.

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